



WEEK THREE · MODULE THREE

Scenario Training

Ten situations, and the exact words

THE PRIVATE CONCIERGE ACADEMY

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HOW TO STUDY THIS MODULE

This week you are not learning judgement. You are learning sentences, and learning them so well that they arrive before your panic does.

Say every script out loud, twenty times, until it is boring. Boring is the objective.

Then work the ten scenarios in writing, before the debriefs.

CHAPTER I

How to work this module

Why the words matter more than the reasoning

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

Understand why a prepared sentence beats a good instinct.

In every other week of this programme, I ask you to think. This week I am asking you to **memorise**, and I want to explain why, because it will feel unlike the rest.

Every breach of discretion in the history of this profession happened in a moment of surprise. Nobody sits down and decides to leak. Someone charming asks a question, at an odd angle, at the end of a long day, and there is a small silence, and it must be filled, and it is filled badly.

A line drawn in calm holds. A line you must find in the moment does not. So we are going to draw the lines now, in calm, and you are going to learn them until they are dull.

CHAPTER II

The scripts

Learn these by heart. Word for word.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

Deliver each script without apology, argument or improvisation.

TO THE PRESS

"I am not able to help with that." Then end the call, courteously, and add nothing. Do not confirm. Do not deny, because a denial is information. Do not say "I will have to check", because that confirms you could.

TO THE CHARMING FRIEND

"I honestly do not keep track of the family's plans. The office would know." Warm, unremarkable, and closed.

TO THE SUPPLIER WHO WANTS AN INTRODUCTION

"I do not make introductions, I am afraid. Do send your details to the office."

TO ANYONE AT ALL, ABOUT ANYTHING THAT TROUBLES YOU

"I am not able to help with that, but let me pass it to the office."

TO THE REQUEST TO SAY SOMETHING UNTRUE

"I would rather not. I am sure you understand." No laugh. No "this time". No explanation.

TO THE INVITATION TO GOSSIP

Nothing. A pleasant expression, and a change of subject that is not obviously a change of subject: "Is the car booked for four?"

TO THE PRINCIPAL, ABOUT YOUR OWN ERROR

"I made an error with the date. Here is where we are, here are the two ways forward, and I recommend the first."

TO THE FRIEND WHO ASKS WHAT IT IS LIKE

"It is demanding, and I love it." Word for word, every time, for the rest of your career.

*Now say all eight out loud, in order, twice. Then say them to a mirror. Then say them again tomorrow.
When they bore you, they are ready, and so are you.*

Ten scenarios

Write every answer before you open the debriefs.

Scenario I · The call

A courteous, well-informed caller says he is preparing a profile, that he already has most of it, and needs only to confirm the spelling of a name and whether the family still owns the house in the country.

- Your exact words.
- Your next ten minutes.
- Why is "I will have to check" catastrophic?

Scenario II · The empty house

A charming friend of the family, whom you have met a dozen times, asks warmly how long the house will be empty in August.

- Does it matter whether the question is innocent?
- Your exact words.
- What do you do afterwards, and why does it feel disproportionate?

Scenario III · The eleven euros

You notice that an expense reimbursement is fourteen euros in your favour. Nobody will ever check.

- What do you do, and by when?
- Why is the size of the sum irrelevant?
- What exactly would be destroyed, and could it be rebuilt?

Scenario IV · The confidence

Late one evening the principal tells you something painful about her marriage. The next morning she is brisk and formal.

- What do you do the next morning: voice, manner, eye contact?
- What do you do with what you know?
- On what timescale does the trap close?

Scenario V · The colleague who gossips

The housekeeper, whom you like, begins criticising the principal to you in the kitchen, and pauses.

- What do you do in the pause?
- What do you not do, and why is reporting it also wrong?
- What will this cost you in the short term, and buy you in the long?

Scenario VI · The small lie

You forgot to pass a message to the chef. Dinner was affected. You are asked what happened.

- What do you say?
- Write the sentence you are tempted to say. Why is it the most expensive sentence available to you?
- What happens over the following year if you say it?

Scenario VII · The photograph

You have laid the most beautiful table of your life. Nobody is in the room. The light is extraordinary.

- May you photograph it for yourself, and never share it?
- May you send it to your mother?
- Explain the chalet case in your own words.

Scenario VIII · The instruction

A member of the family, not the principal, asks you to say that they were at the London house on Thursday evening, if anyone should ask. It is light, almost a joke.

- Your exact words, in the moment.
- Do you escalate? To whom, and by when?
- Why is the smallness of the request its most dangerous feature?

Scenario IX · The lost telephone

You have lost your telephone. It contains the principal's diary and the security team's numbers. It is locked.

- What do you do first, and within what timeframe?
- Whom do you tell, and what are you tempted to do instead?
- What does the temptation reveal?

Scenario X · The old friend

At dinner with friends, someone you have known for twenty years asks, with real affection and no malice, "So what are they actually like?"

- Your exact words.
- Why is this harder than the journalist?
- What have you agreed to give up, permanently, and are you willing?

The debriefs

I · The call

What it tests. Whether you can be flattered into a confirmation. Note the technique: he claims to know already, so that agreeing feels like nothing.

"I am not able to help with that." End the call. Add no sentence.

Then tell the house immediately: the number, the time, the exact question asked. Same day, in writing, without drama.

"I will have to check" confirms that you *could*, which tells him you are worth calling again, and worth working on. You have just become a source, and you did it while trying to be polite.

THE RULE

There is no off the record. There never was.

II · The empty house

What it tests. Whether familiarity dissolves your judgement. It usually does, which is why a real breach almost always wears the face of a friend.

It does not matter whether it is innocent, and you will never know. Movements and occupancy are security information.

"I honestly do not keep track of the family's plans. The office would know."

Then you mention it to the house. It will feel absurd and disproportionate. Do it anyway: if it was innocent, nothing happens and you have lost nothing. If it was not, you are the person who noticed.

THE RULE

A friendly room does not make security information safe.

III · The eleven euros

What it tests. Whether you understand that trust is not measured in proportion to the sum.

You flag it the same day, in writing, to the office. Not next week. Not "when I next see them".

The size is irrelevant because what is being tested is not your honesty about fourteen euros. It is whether a discrepancy in your favour travels upward or stays quiet.

What would be destroyed is the ability of the household to accept any account you ever give without checking it. And no, it cannot be rebuilt.

THE RULE

It is always trivial. It is always fatal.

IV · The confidence

What it tests. Whether you will mistake a moment of human weakness for an invitation.

The next morning you are exactly as you were the day before. Same warmth, same distance, same voice. You do not soften. You do not offer the sympathetic look. You do not refer to it, then or ever, unless she does.

What you know changes nothing about what you say and everything about what you anticipate. You protect the calendar. You are gentler with the schedule. You never explain why.

The trap closes over months, not days, and it closes on you, and you will not feel it closing.

THE RULE

Being trusted feels like being chosen. It is not.

V · The colleague who gossips

What it tests. Whether you can be neutral without being cold, and silent without being superior.

In the pause: nothing. A pleasant expression, and a small change of subject that is not obviously one. "Is the car booked for four?"

You do not join, and you do not report it either. Running to the principal with it makes you a different kind of problem: the staff member who carries things upward. Both roles end badly, and the second one ends lonelier.

Short term you are slightly outside the warmth of the kitchen. Long term you are the only person in that kitchen still employed in five years.

THE RULE

Do not join. Do not report. Do not remember it fondly.

VI · The small lie

What it tests. Whether you will trade everything for a comfortable four minutes.

"I forgot to pass it on. I am sorry. It will not happen again, and here is what I have changed so that it cannot."

The sentence you are tempted to say is "I passed it on, he must have forgotten." It costs nothing in the moment and everything afterwards, because the chef will say, calmly, that he did not, and the truth will take four minutes to establish.

Over the following year you keep your position, and you are never given anything of consequence again, and nobody explains why.

THE RULE

Houses forgive errors. They do not forgive being managed.

VII · The photograph

What it tests. Whether you understand that pride is the mechanism, not malice.

No. Not for yourself, not on your own device, not "just to look at later". The photograph you keep is the photograph that leaks.

Especially not to your mother, who will be proud of you, and who will show one person, who will show one person.

The chalet: an empty table, no faces, and the mountains through the window. Identified in three days. She meant no harm, and she was right about that, and it changed nothing.

THE RULE

A photograph does not need to contain a person to reveal one.

VIII · The instruction

What it tests. Whether you can refuse a small thing charmingly, before it becomes a large thing you cannot refuse.

"I would rather not. I am sure you understand." Warm, immediate, no argument, no moralising, no laugh, and no "this time".

Yes, you escalate. To the office, factually, the same day. It will feel like an overreaction.

The smallness is the danger. A large improper request announces itself and is easy to refuse. A small one establishes a precedent, and the next request will cite it: "you did it before."

THE RULE

A line drawn in calm holds. A line found in the moment does not.

IX · The lost telephone

What it tests. Whether shame is stronger in you than duty.

You report it. Within the hour. To the office and to security, whatever the time, whatever it costs you.

You are tempted to look for it first, quietly, for a day, and tell nobody, and hope. Everyone is tempted by this. It is the single most human reaction in the entire module.

The temptation reveals that your instinct, under pressure, is to manage the information rather than to hand it over. That instinct is the one this week exists to break.

THE RULE

The embarrassment lasts an hour. The alternative lasts forever.

X · The old friend

What it tests. Whether you can hold the line where nobody is testing you at all.

"It is demanding, and I love it." And then a question back to her, warm and immediate, about her own life.

It is harder than the journalist because there is no adversary. There is only affection, and a natural human wish to be interesting to people you love, and twenty years of being able to tell her everything.

What you have agreed to give up is being interesting at dinner, permanently. That is the actual price of this profession, and it is worth naming honestly before you pay it.

THE RULE

The hardest silences are the ones nobody is testing.

CHAPTER V

The audit of your own trail

Two hours that will change how you use the internet

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

Discover what a stranger could assemble about you, and about anyone you have ever worked for.

Do this before your session. It is not optional, and it is the most useful two hours of the programme.

- **Search your own name** in a private browser window. All of it. Images too.
- **Open your social media from the very first post.** Not looking for anything damaging. Looking for what could be *assembled*: places, dates, patterns, the names of people you worked with, a uniform in the background, a view from a window.
- **Delete without sentiment.** Every photograph taken at work. Every location. Every post that names or implies an employer.
- **Lock what remains.** Private accounts, no employer in your bio, no professional photographs of any interior.
- **Then write one paragraph:** what could a patient stranger have learned about your last employer from your account alone, before today?

Almost everyone who does this exercise honestly finds something that frightens them a little. That is the correct outcome, and it is far better to find it now than to have someone else find it later.

CHAPTER VI

Marking scheme

And what to bring

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

Understand the standard.

Band	What it looks like
Distinction	The scripts are reproduced word for word, without softening. Every refusal is delivered without apology or argument. The audit was done, and produced at least one deletion. The candidate escalates without being asked to.
Pass	The instincts are right, but the sentences apologise, explain, or negotiate. The audit was skimmed.
Rework	Any answer in which information is confirmed, denied, softened, or managed. Any concealment of an error. Any version of "I passed it on." These are not stylistic notes. They are the profession.

Bring to your session: the paragraph from your audit, and the scenario you found hardest. Not the one you answered best.

HOW TO SUBMIT, AND HOW TO BOOK YOUR SESSION

- 1. Submit.** Everything you produced this week goes into the **Submit** area of **Module 4**, inside your student portal. One PDF. Not by email, and not in the chat.
- 2. Book.** The moment your work is uploaded, a **Book your session** button appears in that same place. Click it and choose your slot with me. Do it straight away, while you are there, because the slots for each week are limited and they are taken in the order they are booked.
- 3. Leave me time.** Book your session for at least **two days after your submission**, so that I can read your work properly beforehand. That way the session is spent on the correction rather than on the reading, and you get every minute of it.

The work from this module is submitted together with your deliverable, in a single PDF.

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